

Children of the Sea

Most of the rice we eat, the clothes we wear, the medicines we need, even the phones in our hands—almost all of it comes to us by sea. Carried across vast oceans by ships so massive they seem like floating cities, guided by sailors whose names we may never know. This is the story of one such sailor—Rahaat.

From childhood, Rahaat was in love with the sea. Standing on the shores of Patenga, he would spend hours staring at the distant horizon where great ships crawled like giants across the water. The crash of waves, the cries of seagulls, the faint glow of a lighthouse—everything pulled him closer to the mystery of the ocean. In his heart he always wondered: What kind of life unfolds inside those ships? Years later, after finishing his studies, Rahaat entered the marine academy. There he quickly learned that to become a sailor was not just to chase a dream but to embrace discipline, sacrifice, and courage. Long days of training, strict rules, and endless drills molded him into something stronger than he had ever imagined.

Finally, the day came. His first voyage began on a massive cargo ship. The ocean stretched endlessly in every direction, a vast blue desert without borders. The air was thick with salt; the horizon seemed unreachable. At first the sea was calm, almost gentle, and Rahaat thought he had stepped into a world of eternal peace. But the sea does not reveal its true face so easily.

One evening, the sky darkened with alarming speed. Clouds gathered like an advancing army, and thunder split the heavens. Within minutes the waves rose higher than houses, smashing against the ship like a furious beast. The vessel groaned and tilted as if it were nothing more than a paper boat. On deck, Rahaat clung to the railing, his heart racing. Rain lashed against his skin like needles, the wind howled so loud he could barely hear himself breathe. A monstrous wave crashed across the bow, drenching him in icy water. Fear gripped him—What if the ship sinks? What if he never sees home again? Then, through the chaos, the captain appeared. Lightning illuminated his stern face as he placed a firm hand on Rahaat's shoulder and shouted above the storm:

— “The sea terrifies us, but it also teaches us. Stand your ground—this storm will pass. A sailor's greatest strength is courage!”

Those words struck deep. Something inside Rahaat shifted. He straightened, eyes fixed on the raging horizon. The storm roared on, but he no longer felt powerless. By dawn, the tempest faded, and the first rays of sunlight danced on the rippling water. Exhausted yet alive, Rahaat realized he had been reborn—no longer a boy chasing dreams, but a true sailor forged by the sea.

Yet the life of a sailor is not defined by storms alone. There is another kind of hardship: distance. Months away from family, far from familiar faces. Nights in foreign harbors brought memories of his mother's cooking, his father's advice, his sister's laughter. Phone calls home left his throat heavy, but he consoled himself with one truth—through his labor, countless families in his

country received the goods they needed. Years passed. Experience filled his life like the endless tides. Today, Rahaat is an officer. When young cadets tremble at the vastness of the sea, he smiles and tells them:

— “We are all children of the sea. Do not fear it—the waves will guide us.”

The sea tests every sailor, sometimes with calm, sometimes with fury. But in those tests, sailors find their courage, their duty, and their pride. Behind the everyday comforts of our lives lies their silent sacrifice—vast and unending, like the ocean itself.

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